Congress's forty-five (10.8 per cent of all its candidates). By 2019, the BJP had radically improved its representation of women. In the 2019 Lok Sabha poll, it fielded more women than any other political party in India: fifty-five. It narrowly pipped the Congress, which fielded fifty-four women. In proportional representation terms, the BJP's share of women candidates (12.6 per cent) was only marginally behind the Congress's (12.8 per cent). And the party did not just field more women candidates, it fielded strong women candidates who had a substantially higher success rate than female candidates from all the other parties.[71] Two out of every three women who fought on the BJP banner got elected.[72] The result was that the party had the largest number of women MPs in Parliament in 2019: forty-one. A measure of its success was that the BJP's women contingent in the Seventeenth Lok Sabha was over four times larger than the next biggest female cohort, from the Trinamool Congress (nine), and over six times bigger than that of the Congress (six) .[73]

Table 17.1: How the BJP Started Giving More Lok Sabha Tickets to Women Candidates than Other Political Parties in the Lok Sabha Polls (2004–2019)